EPISODIO

# 1

*uno*

# La carta

*The letter*

TEXTBOOK PP. 4–10 · WORKBOOK PP. 3–8

## LO ESENCIAL *In one minute*

1. **Ser** means *to be*: soy, eres, es, somos, sois, son. Use it to say **who** someone is (*Raquel es abogada*) and **where they are from** (*Don Fernando es de España*).
2. **Cognates**: a Spanish word that looks like an English word usually means the same thing (*historia, importante, misterioso*). Watch for false friends: *librería* = bookstore, *colegio* = high school.
3. **Small words, big rules**: *hay* = there is / there are, *un / una* = a / an, and no *un / una* before a job: *Raquel es abogada*.

## EL VERBO *ser · to be*

### ser *to be* IRREGULAR

| SINGULAR | | | PLURAL | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| yo | **soy** | *I am* | nosotros/as | **somos** | *we are* |
| tú | **eres** | *you are* | vosotros/as | **sois** | *you are* |
| él · ella · usted | **es** | *he, she is · you are* | ellos · ellas · ustedes | **son** | *they are · you are* |

REMEMBER — The plural forms all start with **s-**: **s**omos, **s**ois, **s**on.

FOUR WAYS TO SAY you are — **eres** to one friend (*tú*), **es** to one person politely (*usted*), **sois** to a group in Spain (*vosotros*), **son** to a group (*ustedes*). The lessons ahead explain each one.

## GRAMÁTICA *How it works*

### Two jobs for ser

**A = B**

Say what someone **is**.

| | |
|---|---|
| Raquel es abogada. | *Raquel = abogada* |
| Don Fernando es cliente. | *don Fernando = cliente* |

**ser de**

Say where someone is **from**.

| | |
|---|---|
| Raquel es de los Estados Unidos. | *Raquel is from the United States.* |
| Don Fernando es de España. | *Don Fernando is from Spain.* |

### Small rules, big difference

| | |
|---|---|
| *Yo* is optional: the verb already says who. | *(Yo) soy de México.* |
| No *un / una* before a job. | *Raquel es abogada. Juan es profesor de literatura.* |

| | |
|---|---|
| **-s** means more than one, and *es* becomes *son*. | *Juan es mexicano. · Juan y Ramón son mexicanos.* |
| … *y yo* (… and I) takes **somos**. | *Carlos, Juan y yo somos hijos de don Fernando.* |
| **Hay** = there is / there are. | *En la carta hay un secreto.* |
| **un / una** = a, an · **el / la** = the | *una carta · el patriarca* |
| **¿Quién?** for one person, **¿Quiénes?** for more. | *¿Quién es don Fernando? ¿Quiénes son?* |

## VOCABULARIO *Words*

**Learn these first.** The lesson's own word list.

### LAS PERSONAS

| | |
|---|---|
| la abogada | *lawyer* |
| el cliente | *client* |
| el doctor | *doctor* |
| el hombre | *man* |
| la mujer | *woman* |
| el patriarca | *patriarch, male head of the family* |

### LUGARES · COSAS · CONCEPTOS

| | |
|---|---|
| la hacienda | *estate* |
| la carta | *letter* |
| la historia | *story; history* |

### LOS VERBOS

| | |
|---|---|
| ser | *to be* |
| es · son | *is · are* |
| tiene | *he / she has* |
| vive | *he / she lives* |
| hay | *there is · there are* |

### PALABRAS PEQUEÑAS

| | |
|---|---|
| ¿quién? | *who?* |
| yo | *I* |
| de | *of; from* |
| en | *in* |
| muy | *very* |
| para | *for* |
| sí · no | *yes · no* |
| también | *also* |
| y | *and* |

## COGNADOS *Words you already know*

### SPOT THE PATTERN

| SPANISH | ENGLISH | EXAMPLES | |
|---|---|---|---|
| **-dad** | **-ty** | universidad, cualidad | *university, quality* |
| **-ción** | **-tion** | información, combinación | *information, combination* |
| **-oso · -osa** | **-ous** | misterioso, delicioso | *mysterious, delicious* |
| **-ico · -ica** | **-ic** | histórico, esquemático | *historic, schematic* |
| **es- + consonant** | **s-** | España, estudiante, establo | *Spain, student, stable* |

### FALSE FRIENDS · ¡OJO!

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| la **librería** | = **bookstore** | *not library, which is* la biblioteca |
| el **colegio** | = **high school** | *not college, which is* la universidad |

## PRONUNCIACIÓN *How it sounds*

**Cognates look alike but sound different**
Don't read *historia* or *importante* the English way. Copy the speaker on the audio, vowel by vowel.

**The accent mark shows the strong syllable**
lec**ción**, tam**bién**, ¿**quién**?, Ro**drí**guez, jar**dín**.

**H is silent**
**h**acienda, **h**istoria, **h**ombre, **h**ay, **h**ispano: start straight on the vowel.

**Five short vowels**
**a e i o u** always sound the same, short and clean: *sí, no, es, son, muy*.

## FRASES ÚTILES *Ready to use*

| | |
|---|---|
| Soy estudiante de español. | *I'm a student of Spanish.* |
| Soy de __. · Vivo en __. | *I'm from __. · I live in __.* |
| Soy abogada. Don Fernando es mi cliente. | *I'm a lawyer. Don Fernando is my client.* |
| Carlos, Juan y yo somos hijos de don Fernando. | *Carlos, Juan and I are don Fernando's sons.* |
| ¿Quién es? · ¿Quiénes son? | *Who is it? · Who are they?* |
| ¿Quién habla? | *Who is speaking?* |